

No. 740, June 2011

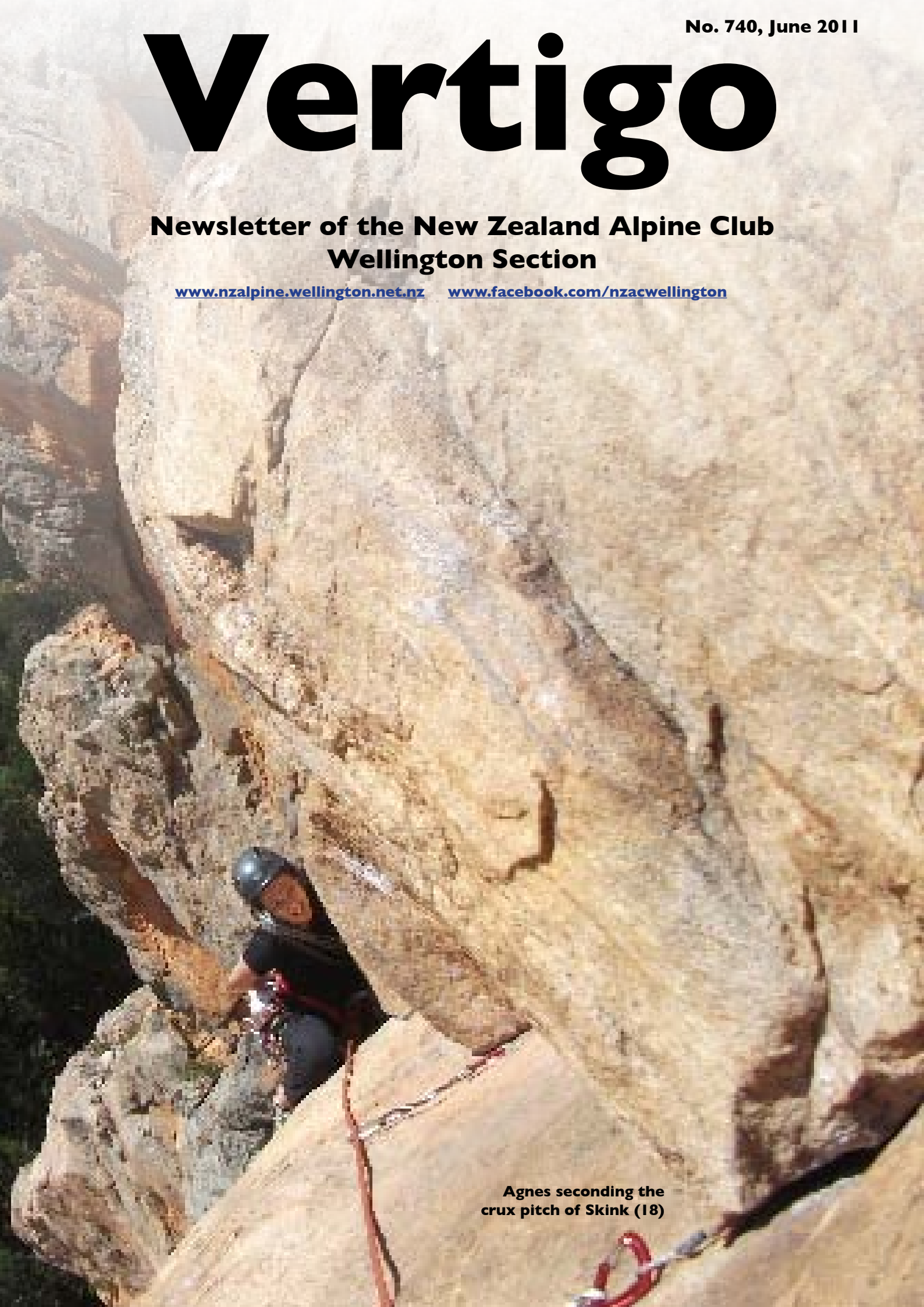
Vertigo

**Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club
Wellington Section**

www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

www.facebook.com/nzacwellington

**Agnes seconding the
crux pitch of Skink (18)**



Next section night: 13 June, 2011

Wellington Section Photo Competition

THE ANNUAL WELLINGTON SECTION photo competition will be held on the coming club night.

A panel of first-rate photographers / pho-connoisseurs will present a selection of the best shots for the audience to choose the winners.

Major prizes this year will include a season ski pass to Mt Ruapehu, a day pack from Macpac and a 10 pass to Ferg's.

Pictures will be judged in the following categories:

- Alpine Activity: climbing, skiing, whatever you do up high
- Alpine General: scenery and views that make you want to come back
- Alpine Nature: the little gems of beauty along the way
- Rockclimbing: hardest moves, slickest lines
- Photo Journalism: the shot that tells a story
- Humour: whatever gets you a laugh



Summit by Richard Young
Honours Alpine General 2010



Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea & coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.

AIC 2011

THE WELLINGTON SECTION of the New Zealand Alpine Club are running its ever popular annual Alpine Instruction Course or "AIC" for 2011 and are now taking names of anyone interested in enrolling for the course.

This is probably the best way to be introduced to the alpine environment, learn techniques, gain some life skills, and meet potential climbing partners. The course takes you from the fundamentals of getting your gear sorted right through to roped climbing and building emergency shelters such as snow caves. The course will cost \$899.

The course will run from June through August and will consist of three weekends on the mountain, a field day and five evening sessions. The specific dates are:

- Course Icebreaker – Wellington: June 21

- Theory Evening – Monday 11 July
- First Weekend – Tukino: Weekend of 15–17 July
- Theory Evening – Tuesday 26 July
- Skills Day – Titahi Bay: Sunday 31 July
- Theory Evening – Tuesday 2 August
- Second Weekend – Tukino: Weekend of 5–7 August
- Theory Evening – Tuesday 23 August
- Third Weekend – Whakapapa: Weekend of 26–28 August
- Course Dinner – Wellington: Tuesday 20 September

For further information or to enrol contact Lorraine Johns at aic@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.



An introduction to the big mountains down south

By Richard Davidson

MATT AND I GRADUATED FROM THE 2010 AIC course with ambitions of climbing some of the bigger peaks down South in the 2010/11 summer. By the time summer rolled around, our list of ascents did not look too flash – attempts on Manukau and Taranaki, success on the Pinnacles Grand Traverse at Whakapapa, and I had Tapuaenuku under my belt.

But we'd booked our trip and had cunningly tricked ourselves into thinking we had enough experience to have a good crack (notwithstanding the discernable doubt on some peoples' faces when we told them what we were doing). Our objectives: Mt Aspiring, and then to check out some peaks in Mt Cook National Park.

Mt Aspiring (27 December–2 January)

We weren't out to set the world on fire with this climb, and had selected the standard route up the West Matukituki, stopping over at French Ridge Hut on our way to the North-West Ridge of Aspiring. We reached French Ridge Hut after a pretty average day with heavy rain and a bit of flooding to navigate – no river crossings on this day. A weather window looked likely on the 29th, and we woke up excited on the 28th looking to knock out the walk to Colin Todd via the Quarterdeck in quick time.

After a morning of heavy mist and weird route decisions (choosing a line of mixed climbing on rock and ice to the Bonar instead of the easier Quarterdeck route), the day cleared with brilliant timing and we were treated to our first glimpse of Aspiring. We roped up to cross the Bonar – our first time ever on a proper glacier. Matt was leading when he thought he spotted some cracks ahead. It was proving tough to spot them as there had been 30cm of snow over the last couple of days.

"Keep the rope tight!" Matt yelled to me, and I vigilantly watched Matt as he tapped his axe around the cracks.

And then Matt fell through through the surface. Instantly I was hurtling along the ground barely able to register what was going on. I slammed my axe in but it popped out of my grip (first lesson: always keep the leash on!). For that split second I was convinced I was joining Matt in the crevasse. But, just as suddenly as Matt fell, I stopped. Maybe a knot had gripped into the lip?

After composing myself somewhat, I built an anchor and checked Matt's condition. He was fine, but a good eight metres down the crack. It was at this point that I wished my crevasse training comprised more than two hours at the Botanical Gardens going over a few systems.

The next three hours were spent trying to get Matt and all of his gear out of the crevasse. It was bloody tough work for the both of us, and I sympathised as Matt hung in there for such a long time. The time was now 8pm and we were conscious of the night closing in. Looking back now, we were bloody lucky. We managed to get by with the basics, but this might not always be the case.

Some lessons learned:

- Don't go into crevassed country if you haven't properly practised rescue. It is really difficult to get someone out of a crevasse, even if they are conscious and uninjured. (We ended up using the assisted hoist method, but this only worked because Matt was able to use his prussicks as well.)
- Keep your leash on (I lost grip of my axe when trying to arrest, and Matt lost his down the bottom of the crevasse).
- Use alpine butterfly knots for the knots intended to bite into the lip. We used overhand knots and it took us an hour at the hut to get them undone – it would have been impossible out in the cold.

We were pretty sketched out by all this and decided to retreat instead of crossing the rest of the Bonar. Reversing our route from earlier in the day, we down climbed a 60 degree slope in the dark, and decided at 1am it would be smarter to bivvy than to continue on.

We made it back to Colin Todd on the 31st but didn't get a crack at Aspiring – we had missed the good weather window and another one didn't come. We barely tolerated some Aussies who had helicoptered in and been guided to the top earlier that day and were rather loud in their celebrations.

Disappointed, but grateful to have not been seriously hurt and with some good experience under our belt, we walked back out the Matukituki valley in sunshine.

Cook National Park (8 Jan – 15 Jan)

The Mt Cook part of our trip was more successful and less dodgy (sort of). Some bullet point highlights will do:

People are not lying when they say the walk up the Tasman Glacier is a killer. It is tough! Our advice is to get off the moraine and onto the white ice where possible. It took us 11 slow hours to get to De La Beche Hut from Ball Shelter.

We made an attempt on the Minarets but, after having some route finding troubles throughout the day, ran out of time.

A fantastic two days where we summited Elie de Beaumont, Green and Walter. We left from Tasman Saddle Hut at 5am, headed up to Divers Col, dumped some bivy gear, went over Walter, rapped down to Climbers Col, up to Elie and back the same way to our bivy spot (15 hours all up). Next day we did Green.

Bivying in the middle of Tasman Glacier. A really strange feeling, but a spectacular scene and it was the best sleep we'd had in nights.

Looking back at our trip now, we are really stoked with our efforts. What we did was at the limit of our experience and often beyond it. The nature of the terrain in the bigger mountains down South is a real step up from anything we had done on the North Island volcanoes and the Kaikoura ranges.

If you're thinking about heading down to the big mountains for the first time, think carefully about your level of experience. On the whole, we were definitely a bit light on experience, but on the flip side we learnt a tonne. Probably the main thing I learnt is that mountaineering isn't about technical skill (that should be a given), it's about judgement, decision making and problem solving.

Lastly, Matt and I want to thank our AIC instructors last year for all their help, in particular Scott Taylor, Mark Vickers and Don French.

Climbers: Richard Davidson, Matt Knarston.

5 Kiwis tackle the Haute Route, 2011

By Blair Leslie

WE DIDN'T NEED A TRANSLATOR to interpret the unfolding scene in the Chamonix supermarché: Raised French voices, accusations of shoplifting by the staff against one of the group of four teenagers, the glaring security guard manhandling the accused, the other three teenagers trying to appear tough in front of their mates...

And then the fight erupted. Bodies clashed in something between a pub brawl and a rolling maul. Biscuits and chocolate bars exploded off the shelves, littering the ground. And the teenage gang were getting the upper hand. Then within seconds Toby had the would-be shoplifter pinned to the floor. Mike leapt his 6ft 4 frame across the second assailant to protect the female shopkeeper from further aggro/injury.

And as quickly as it started it stopped, as the shopkeeper's taser buzzed threateningly "tzzzzzt, tzzzzzt", within a whisker of flooring anybody in striking distance. As the air cleared Nicky and Jen stood in the relative safety of the fruit and veg stall. It seemed there was no major harm done, apart from to the destroyed Easter display stands. I quickly thumbed out euros for the groceries to the available cashier so we could leave before the inevitable arrival of the gendarmes. We rounded the corner and made our escape just as the police van came swinging into view.

How had it come to this? After all the planning for the Haute Route, Europe's most celebrated ski tour, in the year of the 100th anniversary of the "classic route", it was hardly the start we had anticipated. Quite a prelude to the upcoming seven days of ski touring from Chamonix in France to Zermatt in Switzerland, including a crossing of the Italian border. It got our hearts going though.

The Haute Route itself was first completed in 1911 by Marcel Kunz and Prof Roget, two members of the French alpine association. It has since become a classic ski mountaineering tour, completed by scores of skimountaineers every winter and spring. The route starts under the shadow of Mt Blanc, Western Europe's highest peak at 4810 metres and finishes some 180km away under possibly the most celebrated mountain in Europe, the Matterhorn in Zermatt, Switzerland.

Five of us (all kiwi friends through the New Zealand Alpine Club: Toby Johnson, Jen Brown, Nicky McIn-

doe, Blair Leslie and Mike von Gelden) completed the 7 day journey on skis in the last week of March 2011. We began almost one hundred years to the day after the first traverse of the West to East tour, when Kunz and Roget connected the two 'ends' of the route via the steep and exposed face of the Col du Solodan, and the Plateau du Couloir, under the imposing shadow of the Grand Combin (4314 m). There are many variations on the ski tour from Chamonix to Zermatt, but the 1911 route remains the "classic".

Our journey started from Chamonix, where in keeping with the modern approach we took the lift to the top of the ski field with views over the famous Petit and Grand Dru (impressive rock pillars rising to over 3700m each), and of course views to Mt Blanc itself. From there we descended to the first glacier (Agentiere) and stayed at a very comfortable hut which sleeps around 100 people. The huts along the route sleep 60-100, and although certain luxuries are absent (such as tap water, showers or flush loos), there are many other comforts, with hut slippers provided, friendly wardens, and full catering. The food was always good wholesome stuff, with three courses for dinner, a nourishing breakfast, and picnic lunch on request. All for about 50 euros a night.

Mist and snow showers greeted us as we woke for the 6am breakfast on day two. From the hut we skinned up another glacier to the Col du Chardonnet, from where we got out the rope and abseiled down the steep east face into Switzerland (yes, abseiling into a country, particularly Switzerland, was quite cool). Over the next few days the route took us over a number of cols and glaciers with some long ski descents. As the name "Haute Route" (French: "High Route") suggests the route averages 3000 metres and involves some reasonably strenuous ski ascents and descents over crevassed and avalanche-prone terrain. Official itineraries suggest that on average only half of those who start actually complete the route. For us, we were greatly assisted by the excellent written guide of Peter Cliff (1993), *Haute Route Chamonix-Zermatt: Guide for Skiers and Mountain Walkers*.

We had fresh snow after the first day, which was deep but heavy at times. While skiing a gentle slope on the Plateau du Trient on day two, the "freshies" on either side of the main track looked inviting... "Whump" Toby disappeared in a puff of snow. Then "whump" I

was buried. Jen skiing behind could see nothing but the tops of our packs.

The weather was very good to us, with only half a day of grotty weather on day two, and another on day six. Otherwise it was blue skies the whole way and the views over the Alps were absolutely stunning. Even on the sixth day, with mist and light snow fall aiding our decision to stay two days at the very pleasant Vignettes Hut, we were not to be too deterred from venturing out and managed to skin up a local peak, which was the same height as Mt Cook!

The final day was quite a long one, covering 30km, over three cols and six glaciers and during which we skied into and back out of Italy. Strong winds buffeted our route up the glacier du Tete Blanche but disappeared as we reached our final high point, the Col de Vapelline to see the Matterhorn right in front of us – an impressive sight to say the least. We had actually seen it intermittently for the previous two days, and it is impressive from any angle, being the classic alpine 'horn' as the name suggests. From the col the peak of Dent d'Herens is almost as outstanding... so much so that Toby mistook the latter peak and now has a few shots of us on his camera in front of "not the Matterhorn".

That afternoon we had a superb ski descent right down alongside the Matterhorn, and were able to look up onto its very steep flanks covered in a number of formidable hanging glaciers.

The route finishes at the famous ski/mountaineering resort of Zermatt. We arrived at a pub near the top of the field with R&B music playing and blonde ski babes and others sunning themselves in t shirts or less, which was a bit surreal after spending 7 days

in relative wilderness, and a cold beer was just the ticket.

We took the classic route as follows:

Day 1: Chamonix village, France, up the Grand Montets lift access and descent to Argentiere Hut.

Day 2: Over the col du Chardonnet and Fenetre du Saleina to Trient Hut.

Day 3: Descent to Champex village via Val d'Arpette, then overnight in Bourg-St-Pierre village.

Day 4: Climb to Valsorey Hut under the Grand Combin.

Day 5: Over the col du Solodon to Plateau du Couloir and descent down glacier Mont Durand to Chanrion Hut.

Day 6: Climb up the Otemma glacier to Vignettes Hut.

Day 7: A long day covering 30km over the col de l'Eveque, Col du Mont Brule and Col de Valpelline, and descent under the flanks of the Matterhorn to Zermatt.

Geneva has direct flights from London Heathrow. Chamonix is best reached by a 25 euro shuttle from the airport. We stayed in Chamonix at Hotel du Lacs (88 euro for three person room) in Chamonix and in Zermatt at Hotel Banhoff (40 Swiss francs, dormitory bed), and would recommend both places. Huts are booked through the Swiss Alpine Club website (www.sac-cas.ch).

Austria- Otztal Alps Traverse

By John Nankervis

WE SKINNED AWAY FROM LANGTALERECK HUTTE on an exquisite morning, our second day. The frost was hard; to hold our edges on the first steep traverse above the valley floor was tricky. Tim took the lead as we neared the 3000 metre contour. I silently cursed him. Over recent days Rob and I had skied at high altitude above Hochgurgl, Soelden and in the Stubai. Yet Tim, who'd just arrived from London (delayed by that Icelandic guy with the unpronounceable name) seemed well-acclimatised. But relief was at hand! Below the Annkogel Joch, our first pass on the tour, one of Tim's bindings sheared in two under its housing. It could be cobbled together for downhill but not for climbing. I thought to myself that man and his equipment should be in perfect harmony; maybe the binding hadn't acclimatized. Tim was forced to ski back to the hut, and then down to Obergurgl to go shopping for new bindings, dodging wet snow avalanches on the way. Loose arrangements were made for him to meet us somewhere soon.

At a more leisurely pace Rob and I crossed the pass and made expansive turns down the broad névé to the Hochwilde Hutte. Nobody was home. It was unguarded, but the winter quarters were open and comfy and there was hut food... better even than Julie had promised us. Julie and Karen had done all our refuge and village bookings, some in fluent German. But Iceland had turned them into standby passengers. They couldn't leave Wellington in time to join us. The following day was grey and still. We ventured out with light packs but retreated, chastened by the boom and swish of wet snow avalanches in the mist. "Just throw more kindling on the stove for the rest of the day."

By the morning it had cleared, with a skiff of powder on the glacier. It was a long hot climb to the Schalfkogel Joch. But what a reward awaited us. After a short descent on crampons carrying skis, we farmed corn (snow) for 1,000 metres to the valley floor below

the Martin Busch Hutte. Well, I lie just a little. Lower down it turned fiendishly slushy and the slope was littered with bear traps. I got to the bottom where a bridge crossed the stream, thinking Rob would be turning elegantly at my heels. He wasn't, but some time later a figure appeared floundering waist deep on the fragile snow bridges above the stream, carrying but one ski. The other ski was erect in a bear trap somewhere above, unrecoverable for the moment. But with just one ski there was no way Rob could get up the slope to the hut in such wretched snow. Tim was the saviour. He'd just arrived at the hut from the valley. Rob made contact with him by walkie-talkie. The logistics were then obvious: I skinned up to the hut to meet Tim who then skied down carrying one of my skis. Soon we were together again with Rob, as was his wont, tucking into a monstrous apple strudel with his afternoon latte. A huge meal replete with wine followed and the recovery of the lone ski in the frost next morning seemed to become a more attractive proposition.

For two days we skied the nearby glacier and descended from the summit of Similaun (3,600m) on the frontier. It looked hot and smoggy down in Italy. We refrained from shouting down a warning about the coming onslaught from the All Whites. The weather was packing up; it was time to retreat. As we walked into the village of Vent summer had truly arrived. In Innsbruck we dined well and went our separate ways.

April 2010

Those who did the hard work and who should have been there: Julie Melville and Karen Brown

Tinny freeloaders: Rob Rowlands, Tim Stern and John Nankervis.

Arapiles Climbing: Easter 2011 – Otztal

By Kevin Patterson

AFTER A WEEK AT THE ARAPILES I was privileged to join with the Victoria Climbing Club (VCC) for a few days over Easter and send some great routes. Thanks initially to Dan I was able to raise my trad leading game to a solid 18 and then go on in subsequent weeks to take it up to 19 and then 20. After Dan, I climbed with Agnes Grau for three days culminating in my leading one of the greatest lines on the Watchtower Face – “Skink” (18). What follows is a description of that journey.

Skink is a four pitch route on the right side of the Watchtower Face. The first two pitches are the same as the Watchtower Crack (16) which has been observed as “one of the most commanding lines”, and “still echoes to the cries of a thousand struggling leaders”, “undoubtedly John Fahey’s finest hour, the rest of the team swarmed up the rope after him like drowning rats”. Fine literature indeed.

Skink is equally impressive, the third pitch is solid, the roof hangs over you as you edge out into space from the comfort of the Watchtower corner, nothing but 70m of near vertical, polished sandstone beneath your feet!

Agnes and me had had a couple of great days leading up to this. Checkmate (17) had been sent among a number of routes albeit with much cursing. Agnes challenged me on this so we had a bet on Skink - \$1 for each swear word in the fine jar! Agnes lead off on the first pitch (12) which was quite “run out” in places eliciting one “shit”, one “f***”, and two “merdes” - \$4 up already. The initial plan was to split the leads 2:2

but after that epic I inherited the last three – Ace!. Pitch two (14) went solidly.

Pitch three (crux) was where the “interest” started (always a loaded word this), nothing quite like teetering on the face, extending out under the roof on polished holds, desperate to reach the weakness that would “send the route”. Arriving at the corner I could see only one thigh high 10mm nubbin to stand on – gasp! Which had to be rocked over in a balancy move with negligible finger tip holds... “bugger!”. I moved back then forward... three times... then committed, feeling the fear but doing it anyway. No flailing, the rest of the moves came, then before I knew it I was standing on the 100mm wide belay stance – yay! So relieved I relaxed. Placing a wire in the crack above my shoulder, tugged for surety, clipped, I then turned and was about to shout down “safe” to Agnes then noticed the wire had fallen to my feet :o. Suddenly I’m placing two, three, four, five wires!!! But “It’s all good” and the sun is warm on my back. Skink was sent. And the rest completed shortly thereafter.

And the fine jar? 6-1 in my favour. Though I must say “bugger” has been declared a non-swear word by the NZSA following a Toyota ad complaint. So should be 6-0 but we’ll let that one go hehe.

Thanks again to the VCC for the invite and BBQ. And for the hard work they do on tracks around the Arapiles. Truly this place is a magical asset for all who come here.

Kevin Patterson
NZAC - Wellington



Upcoming Club Trips

Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the Wellington Section. Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going. Send your trip ideas, no matter how vague, to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

And remember we love to hear about your trips – send stories to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Ice Climb Meet @ Tukino Lodge – Mt Ruapehu

Five different ice climbing areas to choose from, ranging from 15 minutes to three hours from the lodge: Margaret's Leap Area, Whangaheue Gorge, Cathedral Rocks, North Ridge Prow, and Te Hue Hue / Tukino Peaks.

The New Zealand Alpine Club's Tongariro guidebook says Matihao (Cathedral Rocks) can lay solid claim to having the best ice routes on Ruapehu, yet it seems to be one of the North Island's best kept secret...

DVD ice vids and end of day photos on big screen.

Download the Information Sheet from <http://www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz/wordpress/documents/TUKINO%20ICE%20CLIMB%20MEET%20INFO.doc>

For program and registration contact Toby Johnston meetings@aucklandclimber.org.nz



Mt Ruapehu Ice Climbing / Mountaineering

Date: 5 August to 7 August, 2011

Trip Leader: Rob Hawes

Travel up on Friday after work to the NZAC lodge at Delta Corner for an exciting weekend of ice climbing and mountaineering. On Saturday we will explore "Matihao" Cathedral Rocks with seven standard routes that are one to two pitches. On Sunday we can explore "Tukino" from the crater side, five standard routes but many lines are possible depending on conditions, again one to two pitches or we can make

the traditional and very rewarding Pinnacle Ridge Traverse (grade 2+) likely from top to bottom.

All intending participants on this trip will need to provide experience details and the organizer needs to reserve the right to limit who participates in this trip for safety reasons.

Contact Rob Hawes Wk: 04 474-1277; Cell 0274 470 461 or by email roberth@tfg.co.nz

General info: Hinrich at 04 386 0316 or by email hs@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

NZAC North Island Ski Touring Meet

Date: 24 September to 25 September, 2011

The Auckland Section are running a ski touring meet on Ruapehu. This will follow along the same lines as the ice climbing meet they ran earlier in the year.

The Wellington and CNI sections are invited for a weekend of ski touring based at Tukino Lodge.

For more information contact Toby Johnston meetings@aucklandclimber.org.nz

Mt Tasman

Date: 3 December to 11 December, 2011

Trip Leader: Rob Hawes

Yes this will be a rewarding and challenging climb of New Zealand's second highest peak, for views up and down the main divide, including Mt Cook summit, west out over the Tasman Sea and east to Mackenzie Basin and beyond. We depart after work on the Friday and fly to Pioneer Hut on the Saturday (the back up will be Porters Lodge if weather prevents us from getting in). After smaller warm up climbs clearly the main objective is Mt Tasman. This will be a long day (15+ hrs) to climb the traditional route; a high level of fitness is a must. The route takes us across the glacier up to Marcel Col, over Mt Lendenfeld (a

10,000 ft peak!), and up the North Shoulder to the summit ridge, usually a knife edge at the last. Lots of pitching and protecting the knife edge ridge require good climbing skills.

All intending participants on this trip will need to provide experience details and the organizer needs to reserve the right to limit who participates in this trip for safety reasons.

Contact Rob Hawes Wk: 04 474-1277; Cell 0274 470 461 or by email Roberth@tfg.co.nz

For general info: Hinrich at 04 386 0316 or by email hs@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Notices

FMC Conference

The Federated Mountain Clubs of New Zealand invite you to join us at our 80th anniversary conference Forever Wild? Our conservation lands in the 21st century

11–12 June, Te Papa, Wellington

This conference is for all those who have an interest in public conservation land, for work or play.

Hear from experts, policy-makers, politicians, recreation and conservation leaders, and those who enjoy our wild lands. Discuss what you think the future for conservation land should look like.

See the www.fmc.org.nz/conference for more information. Register now: download a form to print and post, or register online.

Hut Renovations

NZAC is currently in the midst of a busy post-summer huts capital programme, which means a number are temporarily closed – here are the details:

- Unwin Lodge, Aoraki Mt Cook National Park: after all the years of planning and fundraising, construction of the new bunkroom wing is about to begin. Unwin is now officially closed until the end of September.
- Colin Todd Hut, Mt Aspiring National Park: the weather has not quite cooperated with the construction team, so this hut remains closed. We expect the recladding work to be complete by mid April.

- Whangaehu Hut, Tongariro National Park: the recladding and window replacement project on this hut is partially completed, so this hut remains closed until further notice.

A huge thanks to all the club volunteers and DOC staff who are making all these projects possible, and a reminder to all hut users that paying your hut fees does make a huge difference to the club.

Any questions relating to the above huts and projects, see the NZAC website or feel free to contact NZAC national office: office@alpineclub.org.nz

National Indoor Bouldering Series 2011

After the success of last year's inaugural National Indoor Bouldering Series, the 2011 series started at the end of May.

This event is a huge amount of fun, very social, an excellent way to keep your climbing fitness up and a super-duper way of keeping warm in winter!

The dates are:

- Saturday 28th May: The Roxx Climbing Centre, Christchurch,
- Saturday 25th June: Hangdog, Wellington
- Saturday 30th July: Extreme Edge, Panmure, Auckland
- Saturday 27th August: Extreme Edge, Hamilton

For further information see www.alpineclub.org.nz

NZAC Caps and Beanies

NZAC's caps and beanies are back!

But, with a new look. Available online, or via the National Office for \$15 members, \$20 non-members each, plus p&p.

<http://alpineclub.org.nz/product?filter0=30>

New Discount for NZAC members

Macpac are offering a 20% discount off RRP for all NZAC members. (Sign up to the loyalty club must occur. It's free to join <http://www.marpac.co.nz/macpac-wilderness-club/mwc-info>). Discount applies for

in store purchases only at this stage as you will need to show your active NZAC membership card.

For a full list of member benefits see the NZAC webpage: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/membership/benefits>

Raymond Burrell

NZAC Head Office is trying to track down Raymond Burrell, a Wellington Vet 50 year member. If you are able to help please contact Margaret McMahon, Na-

tional Administrator, New Zealand Alpine Club Inc. on 03 377 7595

New Zealand Mountain Film Festival

The New Zealand Mountain Film Festival is starting a new competition for 2011. They are inviting film makers from New Zealand and around the world, amateurs and professionals, to take some raw film footage (30 minutes) from a Wanaka based "Carbon Free" adventure and turn it into a three minute film for judging and screening.

The competition starts on June 10th and editors have just a week to make and submit their film. They will undergo a pre-judging by the Chief Judge, then the

best 10 films will be displayed on our web page and also screened during the festival for festival visitors to judge and pick their favorite.

The three finalists will be re-shown on the last evening of the festival (July 5) and the winner announced. There is a US\$1000 first prize. Entries open June 1.

http://www.mountainfilm.net.nz/nzmff_filmediting-competition.html

Wellington Section 2011/12 contacts list

Position	Name	Email alias*	Phone
Chairperson	James Wright	chairperson	027 472 5561
Vice Chair	Scott Taylor	vicechair	
Secretary	Catherine Moger	secretary or CM2	04 973 1307 (h), or 021 079 0854
Treasurer	Matt Knarston	treasurer	
National Rep	James Wright	JW	027 472 5561
Patron	John Nankervis		
Trips	Hinrich Schaefer	Trips	
Other Committee Members	Richard Davies	RD	
	Matt Knarston	MK	
	Steve Minchin	SM	
	Lorraine Johns	LJ	
	Hinrich Schaefer	HS	
	Rebecca Thomson	RT	
	Vincent Zintzen	VZ	
Other Roles:			
Gear	Marcus Manning	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	Hinrich Schaefer	PLB	
Instruction Convenor	Vacant		
Instruction - AIC	Vacant		
Instruction - Rock	Blair Hiscoke	summerrock or BH	
Library	Derek Richardson	library	
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	
Newsletter Editor	Steve Minchin	newsletter or SM	
Rock Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	Richard Thomson	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
03 3777 595	National Executive Officer	Ollie Clifton	ollie@alpineclub.org.nz



Shed 6 Queens Wharf
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